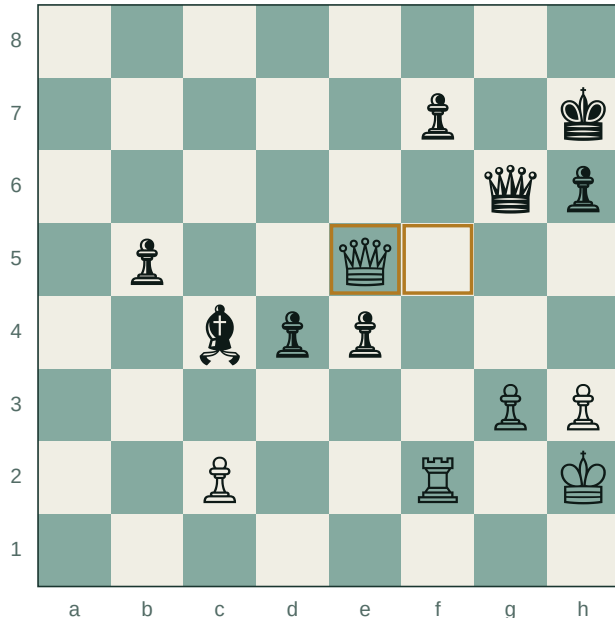


Discovered attacks: Black, move 34

Discovered attacks

Black to move



Previous move: 34.Qe5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

34...e3 35. Rf4 Qxc2+

34...e3 The pawn moves from e4 to e3. Recorded reply: **35.Rf4**.

35...Qxc2+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. The move also takes the pawn on c2.

At the end, nominal material is White 16 / Black 17 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +1:** the balance goes from +0 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Choose the blocker's destination carefully. An uncovered attack may fail if the opponent has a stronger check or can capture the slider.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Moving a blocker can uncover a rook, bishop, or queen attack. The moving piece may create a second threat, giving the defender too many problems at once.

HOW TO LOOK

Find a friendly piece between a slider and an enemy target, then inspect its forcing moves and captures.

The defending king is on h2. Geometrically undefended: queen on e5 and rook on f2. Check for tactical protection.